

COMPATIBLE WITH THE FIFTH EDITION OF DUNGEONS & DRAGONS

SOULSLIKE ROLEPLAYING



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YOU DIED

An immense black shadow sweeps over your corpse. The withered trees of the blighted land shudder from the beating of great wings. Ebonwrath the Blackdrake alights on a nearby cliff, breathing deeply, inhaling the smoldering ashes of your soul.

"You serve me now," the dragon rumbles. "As long as I possess your true soul, I possess you, and you shall be my minions. Guard the gates of my lair while I count my hoard of souls."

Soulslike Roleplaying presents custom rules to bring a soulslike video game style to your fifth-edition-compatible roleplaying game. It provides an adventure background and all the elements you need to begin a deadly, dark-mythic campaign for the **Tales of the Valiant** roleplaying game or any fifth-edition game.

In this game, the PCs are slain by the black dragon Ebonwrath, who claims their souls and locks them in undying servitude to him. To reclaim their true souls, the PCs must, in a sense, become the monsters, slaying enemies and reaving lesser souls until they grow in strength to challenge Ebonwrath in the lowest level of his dungeon lair.

THE FIVE CORE RULES

After the PCs are slain in their first encounter with Ebonwrath, they awaken as soulless, undead hollows next to a smoldering bonfire. Acquaint the players with the five core rules that will define their existence as ravenous undead.

RULE 1. THE SPARK OF LIFE GRANTS GREAT POWER.

With their true souls stolen, the PCs become undead **hollows**. However, various items in the campaign can restore the **spark of life**, temporarily restoring warmth, life, and power to the PC who uses it. This is a new condition, called **spark of life**. While a PC has this condition, they may roll 2d20 and take the higher result once per turn when making the following:

- Attack action
- Cast a Spell action
- skill check
- saving throw

The condition does not end after use. A creature with the spark of life condition keeps it until their hit points drop to 0. Then the condition is lost and the PC once again becomes a hollow. The spark of life grants great power, but exists in a precarious state, easily lost with frequent death.

Spark of life items exist throughout the campaign which can restore this condition. A PC can spend an action to crush such an item, restoring their spark of life. See **The Spark and its Hunters** for more information.

RULE 2. HOLLOW IS A NEW, NON-MECHANICAL CONDITION.

A PC is a **hollow** any time they do not have the **spark of life** or their true soul. A hollow PC appears as an emaciated zombie with necrotized flesh and sunken eyes.

Luckily, this condition has no mechanical penalty. However, being a hollow can make some NPC and item interactions unavailable. Some NPCs are afraid of hollow characters, fearing contagion. Others believe that once you turn to a hollow, there is no coming back.

Being a hollow has at least one non-mechanical benefit, however: it protects the adventuring party from **sparkhunters**, humanoid NPCs who hunt creatures for their spark of life.

RULE 3. BONFIRES ARE SAFE RESTING PLACES.

Bonfires are checkpoints found throughout the adventure. A PC can use a bonfire to teleport to any other lit bonfire they've found. Note that a PC can take a long rest only at a bonfire. This long rest also resets all nearby traps and encounters.

The "safe zone" of the campaign, a place just at the entrance to Ebonwrath's lair, contains a Great Bonfire where the PCs wake up at the beginning of every session. Additional bonfires must be earned.

Each floor of the dungeon can have its own bonfire (where PCs can quickly teleport once they've lit them), but the PCs must explore each floor to find secrets and one of Ebonwrath's underbosses. Once an underboss is slain, the PCs can build a bonfire from its ashes, gaining a deeper foothold into the lair and the recovery of their true souls.

RULE 4. SOULS ARE EXPERIENCE POINTS AND CURRENCY.

Instead of XP and gold, PCs earn **souls** for killing creatures and finding certain items. Combining the two resources means players must consider whether they want to spend souls to buy a shiny new weapon or level up sooner. This manufactured scarcity is offset by monsters resetting after a rest at a bonfire, any found items that provide additional souls, and high-value souls obtained from Ebonwrath's many underbosses.

A PC carries souls with them, but souls aren't physical items. They don't take up space or involve encumbrance. A PC drops all souls they carry when they die at the location where they die. Only Ebonwrath can take gathered souls from a PC by killing them.

Note that this is an asymmetrical, cooperative game. Unless you want to run a brutal (and probably short) TTRPG campaign, disallow PVP at the table.

RULE 5. DEATH IS NOT THE END.

The rule underpins all the other rules. When a PC drops to 0 HP, they do not make death saves and are not killed. Instead, at that moment, the PC instantly reappears at the last bonfire where they took a long rest. Any souls they gathered are left on the spot where they died.

To recover those souls, the PC must travel to where they died and take the Use an Object action to pick them up. Only the PC who dropped souls can pick up those souls again.

HEALING AND SOULS

When the PCs return to rest at the Great Bonfire, an NPC awaits them, the **flame minister** Burwenna. The flame minister is an ally for PCs and a source of information, equipment, and occasional gifts. The flame minister is their first friend, one of a precious few, in a dark and hostile worlds. She tends to the PCs as if she were tending to the last guttering fire in a world growing ever colder.

To begin, the flame minister gives each PCs a choice of a beginner's trinket and a magic item, a *goldcinder vial*. Where the PCs are going, they'll need the help.

Other flame ministers are scattered throughout the world, and some enemies carry the souls of flame ministers they have blasphemously slain.

GOLDCINDER HEALING

The PCs need to be properly equipped to search for their true souls. The first item on the list is the *goldcinder vial* (a personalized replacement for *potions of healing*), followed by souls, by which all things are valued.

Goldcinder Vial

Wondrous Item, Very Rare

Priceless

A *goldcinder vial* is a personal healing item specific to each PC that cannot be shared or used on others. A *goldcinder vial* starts with 3 charges. A charge can be expended as a bonus action to regain hit points.

The *vial* can be upgraded up to three times by gifting a flame minister's soul to a flame minister NPC found at a lit bonfire. See the **Goldcinder Vial Upgrades** table for the number of hit points recovered with each use. A *goldcinder vial* regains all spent charges after finishing a long rest.

GOLDCINDER VIAL UPGRADES

Flame Minister Souls Needed	Healing Effect
0	Goldcinder Vial. Use to regain 2d4 + 2 hit points.
1	Greater Goldcinder Vial. Use to regain 4d4 + 4 hit points. Maximum charges becomes 4.
2	Superior Goldcinder Vial. Use to regain 8d4 + 8 hit points. Maximum charges becomes 5.
3	Ultimate Goldcinder Vial. Use to regain 12d4+12 hit points. Maximum charges becomes 6.

SOULS AS CURRENCY

Souls are the currency by which most things are paid for within this campaign. Souls buy character levels, equipment, crafting, upgrades, and even the services of those few wretched creatures who have not yet become hollows.

Coins and other forms of currency have no value, only souls. Use the **Soul Currency** table to convert between coins and souls. Convert any starting gold to souls upon character generation.

SOUL CURRENCY

Precious Coin	Souls	Precious Coin	Souls
Copper Piece	1	Gold Piece	100
Silver Piece	10		



METHODS FOR GAINING SOULS

Gathering souls is crucial for success. Here's how you get them:

- A PC earns souls equal to the XP that would normally come from a slain monster. Each PC receives the full amount of souls; do not split them among the party.
- **Lost soul items** are scattered throughout the campaign wherever gold, jewels, art objects, or other lootable wealth would normally appear in a dungeon. A PC can spend an action to crush a lost soul item to gain its value according to the **Lost Soul Items** table, or you can carry the lost soul in your inventory to preserve its value against possible death or for later barter. Crushing a lost soul item awards souls to the PC who spent the action to activate it.
- Killing a boss monster awards souls equal to the XP that PCs would normally gain, as well as a **boss soul item** that can be used for crafting, bartering, or just to crush like a single-use lost soul item and gain an appropriate number of souls.
- **Flame minister souls** are all that remain of the wise flame ministers who tended the bonfires and kept the light from dying. Use them like lost soul items to gain 5,000 souls or to upgrade a *goldcinder vial*.

Lost soul items come in a variety of values, ranging from stupefied wizards to defense-stripped dragons. These soul vessels represent the poor creatures who succumbed to Ebonwrath's predation and became permanently hollow, withering away until only the value of their souls remains.

The **Lost Soul Items** table includes relevant die sizes at the appropriate intervals on the table. When a reward is due, roll the size that corresponds to the level of potential reward. Use gold piece rewards from a standard game as a guide for when to increase the die size for lost soul items rewards.



LOST SOUL ITEMS

Dice	Soul Item	Worth in Souls
1	<i>Soul of a Mindless Wizard</i>	100
2	<i>Soul of a Repulsive Sorcerer</i>	500
3	<i>Soul of a Wretched Warlock</i>	800
d4	<i>Soul of a Beggar Bard</i>	1,000
5	<i>Soul of a Lonesome Druid</i>	2,500
d6	<i>Soul of a Guilty Rogue</i>	3,750
7	<i>Soul of a Faithless Cleric</i>	5,000
d8	<i>Soul of a Benighted Monk</i>	7,500
9	<i>Soul of a Disgraced Paladin</i>	10,000
d10	<i>Soul of a Defeated Fighter</i>	12,750
11	<i>Soul of a Lost Ranger</i>	15,250
d12	<i>Soul of a Broken Barbarian</i>	17,500
13	<i>Soul of a Fangless Vampire</i>	20,000
14	<i>Soul of a Hollowed Golem</i>	23,500
15	<i>Soul of a Conquered Giant</i>	28,000
16	<i>Soul of a Rebuked Mummy</i>	33,500
17	<i>Soul of a Beaten Sphinx</i>	38,000
18	<i>Soul of a Fallen Angel</i>	43,500
19	<i>Soul of a Redeemed Demon</i>	55,000
d20	<i>Soul of a Scaleless Dragon</i>	60,000

In addition to finding lost souls throughout the game, GMs can award lost soul items for engagement between sessions, letting PCs earn souls and sometimes even regain a spark of life for activities such as sharing maps, pictures they make of the dungeons and enemies, or journal entries.

NEW COMBAT TACTICS

In this world, the ways to die are endless. You can be caught in any number of traps, crushed by a giant demon's hammer, drop into lava, fall victim to a vicious backstab, and so much more. But the primary way in which you deal your own brand of death is through battle. You'll need new combat options to face the dangers of this bleak place.

REACTIONARY MEASURES

This kind of campaign allows for all the typical character classes, but it focuses more on martial combat. To this end, anyone—not just archetypal fighters and rogues—can do two things in the warrior's wheelhouse: evade combo attacks and parry blows before delivering critical counterattacks.

The following two reactions allow anyone, whether a glass cannon wizard or an armored juggernaut, to take their survival into their own hands.

REACTION: COUNTER

When a Humanoid targets you with a melee weapon attack (but not an unarmed strike or improvised weapon) you can use your reaction to redirect the attack and expose your attacker.

Make a special weapon attack roll called a **counter check**. If your counter check result is higher than the attack roll that triggered this reaction, you take no damage from the attack targeting you, and the first attack against the target next turn ignores the AC bonus from any armor they wear. In addition, you have advantage on your counter check when you wield a Finesse weapon.

The first attack of a Multiattack cannot be countered. If your counter check fails, the attack targeting you automatically succeeds, even if its initial attack roll missed you.

REACTION: EVADE

When an attacker targets you with a Multiattack action, you can use your reaction to evade harm. Make a STR (Athletics) or DEX (Acrobatics) check (your choice) contested by the attack roll of the Multiattack targeting you that you use your reaction on. If the result of your check exceeds the contesting attack roll, you take no damage and move to an adjacent space without incurring opportunity attacks.

When you use your reaction to evade, you can evade a number of attacks from a single target up to your proficiency bonus (PB).

You have advantage on your check to evade if you are wearing light armor or no armor. You have disadvantage if you are wearing heavy armor or are encumbered.

THE ART OF BATTLE

Even stripped of their precious true souls, the PCs of this campaign are warriors without peer, wielding weapons with unique, limited-use movesets offering tactical advantages such as inflicting conditions and covering ground.

The weapon options found in the **Tales of the Valiant Player's Guide** work as a perfect medium for these movesets with one significant change. In **Tales of the Valiant** games, weapon options are included as default abilities for their associated weapons, available to anyone who wields the weapon. (If you don't have the Player's Guide, you can also find weapon options in *Tome of Heroes*.)

In a Soulslike campaign, a GM might instead restrict access more tightly with an optional rule. Consider providing one weapon option to any PC that has the Martial Action class feature (fighter, paladin, ranger), while the rest are limited to use by those who discover them through *martial scrolls*. GMs take note that this requires



some work on your part to offer PCs opportunities to learn new weapon options in a similar way that wizards learn spells from spell scrolls. Drop them in as treasure every few sessions to provide another kind of treasure and ability to power up.

OPTIONAL RULE: WEAPON OPTION LIMITS

When you gain an Improvement by leveling up, you learn one new weapon option on top of other benefits gained by that feature. In addition, you may use weapon options a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus (PB). You regain all uses when you finish a short or long rest.

Martial Scroll

Wondrous Item, Uncommon

1,000 souls

A *martial scroll* contains the knowledge and instruction of a complex attack called a weapon option (see *Player's Guide*). You can spend 1 workweek of downtime and 50 souls' worth of practice supplies to learn the weapon option described on the scroll. Alternatively, you can spend a short rest of intense study and make a DC 15 INT (Investigation) or DC 15 STR (Athletics) check. On a success, you immediately learn the weapon option. On a failure, you must try again during a different short rest.

Scribing a Martial Scroll. Anyone proficient in a weapon option and calligrapher's tools can scribe a *martial scroll* of a weapon option they know. Doing so requires 2 workweeks of downtime and 50 souls' worth of calligraphy supplies.

Using a Martial Scroll in Combat. You can use a *martial scroll* in battle by interacting with an item to wrap it around an appropriate weapon for the option before taking the Attack action. This allows you to use the weapon option on the scroll as if you knew it. Using a *martial scroll* in this way destroys it immediately after the Attack action, regardless of success.

SHIELDS

A few new shield options also improve character survivability.

Parrying Shield. This handheld buckler offers minimal protection but is ideal for executing technical dueling maneuvers. While wielding a *parrying shield*, double your PB when you make a counter check.

Spear Brace Shield. This is a typical targe or kite shield with a hole cut out of the side and reinforced for use with polearms. This allows a weapon to be extended through the hole while the wielder stays protected behind the shield.

SHIELDS

Item	Cost in Souls	AC Bonus	Feature	Weight
Parrying shield	20	+1	Double PB on counter checks	2 lb.
Spear brace shield	50	+2	Spears and tridents have Reach	5 lb.
Tower shield	500	+3	15 STR required, disadvantage on Acrobatics and Stealth checks	30 lb.



When wielding a spear or trident together with a *spear brace shield*, treat your weapon as if it had the Reach property.

Tower Shield. This huge, door-sized shield offers superior protection but heavy taxes the wearer. In addition to the AC bonus while wielding it, you also have resistance to all damage types dealt by nonmagical ranged attacks. *Tower shields* require a minimum strength to wield effectively and a wielder has disadvantage when making DEX (Acrobatics) and DEX (Stealth) checks.

THE SPARK AND ITS HUNTERS

When you have the spark of life, you enjoy the power of warmth and vitality. However, ravenous NPCs known as **sparkhunters** can sense that vitality, and they hunt you down to consume your spark. This offers a tricky choice for the players, as possessing the spark of life makes them more powerful, but it also makes them a target.

THE SPARK OF LIFE

The spark of life is both an item and a condition. You can find *spark of life* items throughout the game. *Spark of life* items weigh nothing and it takes an action to consume one. After you consume the item, you gain the spark of life condition.

While you have the spark of life condition, you have advantage on most checks (see **The Five Core Rules**), and you lose the condition whenever you drop to 0 HP.

You can acquire the spark of life condition in the following ways:

- Some creatures drop *spark of life* items when they die.
- *Spark of life* items can be found in limited quantities as treasure, in chests, or out in the open.
- *Spark of life* items can be bought in limited quantities from NPCs that offer to trade. Most NPCs must first be found and invited back to the Great Bonfire for trading.
- A *spark of life* item is always rewarded after surviving an encounter with a sparkhunter.

SPARKHUNTERS

Sparkhunters are Humanoids eager to return PCs to a hollow state. A sparkhunter only shows up when at least one PC has the spark of life condition, and it always shows up near the same place, materializing from a gust of swirling ash. The sparkhunter prioritizes killing any PC with the spark of life condition.

While a sparkhunter is within 1 mile of a PC, that PC can't rest at or teleport to any bonfire. If a PC dies, they must wait to resurrect until the other PCs in the fight are either dead or the sparkhunter dies.

A fight with a sparkhunter is a deadly prospect, but a lucrative one. Sparkhunters fight to the death and employ cruel methods to win. When a PC kills a sparkhunter, every PC present gains a number of souls equal to the experience award for the sparkhunter's CR as well as 1 spark of life for every PC that did not die during the encounter.

Prepare to face these invaders where they dwell:

Lupine Ravager Torphin. Torphin howls when he attacks, throwing himself into the fray. He is a **wolf reaver dwarf** (see *Tome of Beasts 1*) and launches his ambush when a PC with the spark of life approaches the cavern entrance in the southern part of Giants Fall Ruins. He attacks alone.

Graveslayer Bardolf. Bardolf is a corrupted **graveslayer dwarf** (see *Creature Codex*) who attacks PCs with a spark of life when they are already locked in combat with other monsters.

Twin Lordlings, Eaenod and Doneae. These two knights work in harmony. They lie in wait until the PCs have spent themselves facing other foes.

Cyneburg, Baron of Brass. Cyneburg employs some of the enigmatic mechanist's tools and magic as he hunts for the spark of life. He is a **gear mage** (see *Creature Codex*) and is always accompanied by three **clockwork soldiers** (see *Creature Codex*).

Friyith, Cavalier of Night. This **black knight commander** (see *Tome of Beasts 1*) uses long, narrow corridors to charge into her foes with breakneck abandon.

Siissilith, Princess of Venom. Sissilith is a **half-green dragon veteran**. Like her breath, her weapons are poisoned to deal an extra 14 (4d6) poison damage with every hit.

Macabre Prince Koldric. Koldric waits in a shrine where the **breathstealer** (see *Tome of Beasts 3*) readies to steal breath and the spark of life in equal measure.

Engleadni, Careless Prime of Grief. This **psychophant cultist** (see *Tome of Beasts 3*) uses her powers of psyche to batter her foes into submission.

Scion of Void Wulmar and Black Anchorite Botild. This **voidwracked mage** and his **void speaker apprentice** (see both in *Creature Codex*) wait to ambush the PCs where the essence of the Void is thickest.

Delirious Herald of the Sun Rimil. This **first commander** (see *Tome of Beasts 3*) once praised the sun but now seeks to only bring darkness upon his foes.

Yric, Gravelord Missionary. This **shadow fey poisoner** (see *Creature Codex*) breaks the rules of honorable battle, hiding and waiting to isolate a foe.

Infested Trio: Tuold, Forwin, and Godelina. These three **infested duelists** (see *Tome of Beasts 3*) practice their cruel swordplay to Ebonwrath's sinister delight at the lowest depth of his dungeon, the Ebon Lake of Wrath.

OPTIONAL DIFFICULTY

If a sparkhunter isn't challenging enough for your group, a GM can allow them to use counter and evade reactions as well as any appropriate weapon options. In addition, if the invader is outnumbered or outclassed, apply the following legendary actions template, as needed.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The sparkhunter can take three legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The sparkhunter regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Attack. The sparkhunter makes one attack of its choice at the nearest target.

Move. The sparkhunter moves up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Sparkhunter's Shadow (Costs 2 Actions). The sparkhunter gains all the benefits of spark of life for 1 round. It can only do this once per long rest.

Sparkhunter's Retort (Costs 2 Actions). The invader casts *counterspell* at 3rd level using its choice of INT, WIS, or CHA as the spellcasting ability.

BEGINNING THE ADVENTURE

With the rules, items, combat options, and cruel NPC in place, we're ready to kick off the adventure and the first boss encounter with the campaign's primary villain, Ebonwrath the Blackdrake!

ADVENTURE BACKGROUND

When the dragons were betrayed during the Age of Ancients, Ebonwrath the Blackdrake escaped, stealing a few embers of Primal Flame before finding a hole to hide in. There, Ebonwrath slept in an underground lake beneath the troubles of the ages above.

When the black dragon woke, Ebonwrath rekindled his stolen flame, perverting it with vile magic to steal the souls of lesser creatures. These soulless hollows were doomed to guard Ebonwrath's lair so long as he kept their true souls.

Now, plunderers and thieves turn their gaze anew to Ebonwrath's domain, hoping to take the dragon's stolen hoard. Thinking that all dragons were slain, some of these plunderers might be the PCs.



GIANTS FALL RUINS BATTLE SITE

Giants Fall Ruins sits atop a hill as a collection of crumbling pillars and a crushed mausoleum. It once stood as a memorial to honor long-dead priests and lords of Carim. Now, the location offers only bleak respite that Ebonwrath exploits, luring in weary travelers to slay and enslave.

FIRST ENCOUNTER: EBONWRATH'S FLIGHT

Before the PCs can explore the area, Ebonwrath the **adult black dragon** descends. This combat encounter is meant to kill the PCs and forms the basis of the campaign.

The battle should last only a few rounds, depending on the number of PCs. Ebonwrath brutalizes foes in combat, holding off using his Breath Weapon until after the third turn, preferring to leap on and maul PCs individually. If anyone is alive at the end of five turns, the dragon casts *circle of death* (DC 18) to slay whomever remains.

As the PCs die, they hear the dragon speak, declaring that they shall be wardens for his lair unto eternity. Ebonwrath then retires to the lowest floor of his lair.

GIANTS FALL RUINS GATHERING HUB

Here, the PCs learn where this is all going.

SECOND ENCOUNTER: BURWENNA'S WARM WELCOME

The PCs wake up later, undead and hollow, but comforted by the flames of their first bonfire, the Great Bonfire. Here they meet the first NPC of the adventure, Flame Minister Burwenna. She frets over them and notices that a couple of other NPCs have entered the area now that the dragon is gone. Burwenna's first words to the players are as follows:

"Welcome to the bonfire, Soulless Ones. I am Flame Minister Burwenna. I tend to the flame, and tend to thee. Ebonwrath has stolen your souls, and the souls of all who are resigned to this place. You must take them back. To this end, I am at thy side."

POINTS OF INTEREST

Crushed Ruins. This mausoleum is the focal point on the hill despite its missing roof and crumbling walls. Debris litters the interior while thick plants choke the ground around the exterior. Spiral stairs inside spin downward 60 feet to the first floor of the lair.

Hidden Treasure. The upper room of the ruins contains an unlocked chest with the *soul of a mindless wizard* (100 souls). In the lower room at the bottom of the stairs, a crushed humanoid skeleton in the rubble clutches a *spark of life* item. PCs can find it with a successful DC 17 WIS (Perception) check.

A ledge halfway down the staircase tunnel has a shovel and a *martial scroll* on it. The scroll contains the GM's choice of weapon option or is a 1st-level *spell scroll*. Leaping to the ledge requires a successful DC 15 STR (Athletics) check to jump safely. On a failure, the PC falls to the bottom of the staircase and takes 1d6 falling damage for every 5 feet fallen. This could be the adventure's first (non-Ebonwrath) death. When a PC dies, they drop all of their souls and start the next turn at the last bonfire where they rested.

Near the spiral steps crouches the Disconsolate Warrior.

The Great Bonfire. Outside the mausoleum and sequestered in the corner of two freestanding walls, a bonfire rages. Flame Minister Burwenna stays here, tending the flames. This is the primary resting point for the adventure. PCs can only take a long rest or level up at a bonfire.

FLAME MINISTER BURWENNA

Burwenna is a small-statured human mage shrouded in sooty robes. She always wears a hood over her face, hiding her hair and bandaged eyes.

Personality Traits: Burwenna is kind and noble. She speaks with Olde English formality.

Bonds: Burwenna's soul is stolen like all the rest in Ebonwrath's domain.

Flaws: Burwenna is prone to fear.

Wants: Burwenna clings desperately to the hope that someone will save her and everyone else from Ebonwrath. She also wants the souls of her flame minister kin returned.

Talking to Burwenna: Burwenna is certain that the PCs are there to save everyone from Ebonwrath. She offers her full cooperation. She doesn't respond to intimidation attempts, but is easily convinced with persuasion, while deception attempts are only moderately effective. She can relate the following:

- She's lost count of how long she has been here. She knows the PCs are the first of their kind she has seen in decades.
- She knows that goblins live in the dungeon and are led by a laughing man.

Burwenna explains the stakes and offers the PCs what little help she can. The primary quest is for the PCs to delve into the lair to free their true souls and everyone else's too. Burwenna further explains that the PCs can always rest at her bonfire, that she will help them grow stronger, and that she has a burial gift to commemorate their first death: a *goldcinder vial* for each PC.

Now the PCs may explore Giants Fall Ruins and meet the other two NPCs here.

DISCONSOLATE WARRIOR

The Disconsolate Warrior is a glum human veteran wearing chainmail. He sharpens a broken sword as he guards the steps down into Ebonwrath's lair.

Personality Traits: The Disconsolate Warrior is depressed. Every word beleaguers him.

Bonds: The Disconsolate Warrior's soul is stolen like all the rest in Ebonwrath's domain.

Flaws: The Disconsolate Warrior is prone to despair.

Wants: The Disconsolate Warrior wants to feel hope again. He also desires a magical weapon.

Talking to the Disconsolate Warrior: The Disconsolate Warrior relates the following:

- All is pointless, and he has accepted his fate as Ebonwrath's doorman.
- He doesn't remember why he's here. In fact, he is supposed to bar entry to Ebonwrath's lair. If reminded of this duty, he becomes hostile and attempts to kill the PCs, sending them right back to the bonfire. If approached a second time, he is no longer hostile and yields access easily. He reasons that if the PCs return from the bonfire so quickly, there's no point in blocking them.
- To reinvigorate the Disconsolate Warrior, a successful DC 15 CHA (Intimidation) or DC 15 CHA (Persuasion) check brings him around.

Five Saints Statues. A row of statues to the south of the bonfire depicts five knights in poses praising the sun. To recognize the knights as Carim priests and that their leader, Baldred, should be buried in the mausoleum or the tomb below it: DC 13 INT (History) check. Winnifrid of Courland stays here, examining the statues.

Hillside Cavern Entrance. The cavern opening at the far southern end of the hill is covered by overgrowth. A successful DC 13 WIS (Perception) check reveals it. A nearby tree shades a mound that any nearby PC instantly recognizes as buried treasure. However, a shovel is required to dig up the mound, which takes 10 minutes. Inside, a chest that holds 5 *firebombs*.

CONCLUSION

The fight with Ebonwrath, exploring Giants Fall Ruins, and interacting with the three NPCs is enough to fill three to five hours of play. The Hillside Cavern Entrance offers an entrance to the eleven floors of Ebonwrath's lair.

From here, you can create your own dungeon levels or use existing adventures such as the megadungeon in *Scarlet Citadel*. Make sure that each level of the dungeon contains a boss monster and plenty of opportunities for sparkhunters to invade the PCs' lives. Never worry about being too hard or killing the PCs. They'll always be back!

WINNIFRID OF COURLAND

Winnifrid is a young human priest with short blond hair. She carries herself with poise and wears a heavy-looking breastplate and stifling white vestments.

Personality Traits: Winnifrid is courteous but cautious at first. In time, she can become irritable, frantic, and overly familiar if her interests are not met.

Bonds: Winnifrid's soul is stolen like all the rest in Ebonwrath's domain.

Flaws: Winnifrid is prone to obsession.

Wants: Winnifrid is obsessed with finding relics in the local area.

Talking to Winnifrid: Though reserved at first, Winnifrid is a quest giver for several important tasks.

She doesn't respond to deception attempts but is easily convinced with persuasion. Intimidation is only moderately effective. If she is either approached multiple times or the PCs take their first long rest at the Great Bonfire, Winnifrid asks them for help with several tasks:

- Winnifrid seeks an artifact tool kit called a *transposed kiln*. If found and returned to her, it enables the PCs to craft transposed weapons from collected boss souls.
- Winnifrid is looking for her grandfather's holy symbol, the *Courland Devotional Bell*. She believes her grandfather was buried here with the other priests and she has come for what is rightfully hers.

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